What is mixed digital methods?

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Agenda

Brainstorming and ideas sharing

- What makes a good case?

Tentative RQ and data sites

- Brainstorm for potential cases, RQs and data sites

Introductions

Assignments and exam

- Groups are pre-formed, ideally 3-4 people (class formation will be finished before Easter)
- One slide update **every Tuesday**, after Easter

- Milestones (via email to TA):
  - Research topic, RQ, and central datasites – **25th of April**
  - Updated RQ, data collection plan, and preliminary analysis – **2nd of May**
  - Data collection, analysis design, and initial analysis updates – **16th of May**
  - Presentations – **30th of May**

- Final exam:
  - hand-in **6th of June**
  - oral exams **Week 25**

Any questions from the lecture?

Next up:
Brainstorming and ideas sharing

What makes a good mixed methods case?

- Discuss in your groups for 5 minutes.
  - Could draw on literature, lecture examples, current events.
- Plenum – key takeaways.

Brainstorming for case topics

- Afterwards, take 10 minutes to empty your heads and write down **one or more interesting topics.** Be generous.
- Once decided on some of your ideas, add them to this **Padlet**: https://tinyurl.com/3vdtcz5v

Break for 15 minutes

Next up:
Tentative RQs and data sites

Shortlisting case ideas

- Based on your previous brainstorming, get into your groups and try to settle on a **shortlist of topic ideas**.
  - Discuss strengths and weaknesses of each, specificity and applicability.
- Consider what an interesting **research question** for the topic(s) would be, what **kinds of data** and **data sources** one would want and need to answer the research question, by way of the methods taught in this course.

- In plenum, groups report their 1-2 '**best topic/question**', i.e., the ones they like the most.
- Then, the **groups will be paired** based on a 'maximum variation principle' – you speak with people who have fairly different topics/questions.

Break for 15 minutes

Shortlisting case ideas

- In groups, the task (30 min) is to **challenge** each other, in a constructive way: ask questions about the **topic/question**, and **feasibility** of data, methods, suitability for mixed methods research, etc.
- In final plenum, groups will present again their 1-2 'best topic/question', possibly **revised** in light of feedback. This will be the starting point for next time, when everybody will self-select into their preferred topic/question at the start of the exercise.

Tak for i dag!

Next time: Research question and mixed research designs

Seminar on Thursday: Preliminary research, RQ, and design

- Frederiksen, Morten, Jonas Toubøl, and Hjalmar Bang Carlsen. “Theory and Design” "Mixed Methods: A Primer for Sociologist." 49-73 (24 pages).
- Grigoropoulou, N., Small, M.L. The data revolution in social science needs qualitative research. Nat Hum Behav 6, 904–906 (2022). (10 pages)